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# Financial help if you're disabled

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# VAT relief for disabled people

If you’re disabled or have a long-term illness, you will not be charged VAT on products designed or adapted for your own personal or domestic use. Also, you will not be charged VAT on:

- the installation and any extra work needed as part of this
- repairs or maintenance
- spare parts or accessories

> The product and your disability have to qualify.

## Qualifying products or services

Your supplier can tell you, but usually products designed or adapted for a disability (/government/publications/vat-relief-on-certain-goods-if-you-have-a-disability) qualify. For example, certain types of:

- adjustable beds
- stair lifts
- wheelchairs
- medical appliances to help with severe injuries
- alarms
- braille paper or low vision aids - but not spectacles or contact lenses
- motor vehicles (/government/publications/vat-about-purchasing-zero-rated-adapted-vehicles-guidance-for-customers-vat1615) - or the leasing of a motability vehicle
- building work (/government/publications/vat-relief-on-building-work-if-you-have-a-disability) like ramps, widening doors, installing a lift or toilet

## How to get the product VAT free

To get the product VAT free your disability has to qualify. For VAT purposes, you're disabled or have a long-term illness if:

- you have a physical or mental impairment that affects your ability to carry out everyday activities, for example blindness
- you have a condition that's treated as chronic sickness, like diabetes
- you're terminally ill

You do not qualify if you're elderly but not disabled, or if you're temporarily disabled.

You'll need to confirm in writing (/government/publications/vat-reliefs-for-disabled-people-eligibility-declaration-by-a-disabled-person) that you meet these conditions. Your supplier may give you a form for this.

## Help from your council

You can apply to your council for equipment or help (/apply-home-equipment-for-disabled) to adapt your home if you have a disability.

## Importing goods

You do not pay VAT if you import qualifying goods (/guidance/reliefs-from-vat-for-disabled-and-older-people-notice-7017) that are for your own personal or domestic use. This includes certain goods for blind and partially sighted people.

If you use a freight service they can help you with the paperwork, otherwise make sure the following is written on parcel, 'Goods for disabled people: relief claimed'.

If you bring them in yourself, declare them in the red channel at Customs. For any other method of import, contact the National Import Reliefs Unit (/government/organisations/hm-revenue-customs/contact/national-imports-reliefs-unit).

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